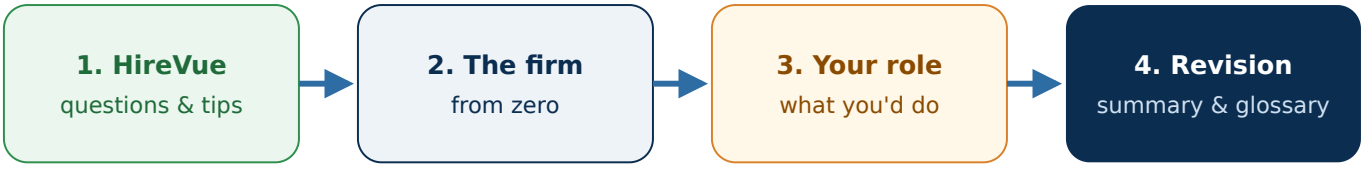
COMPLETE GUIDE · FROM ZERO

St. James's Place: the complete guide

How the firm works, who it serves, how it makes money, where it's going, and how to ace the HireVue



How to use this guide

- **No prior knowledge needed.** Every term is explained the first time it appears, and there's a glossary at the back.
- **Short of time?** Read the HireVue pages, "What is SJP?", "How SJP makes money", "What makes SJP different" and the 60-second summary.
- Box colours: **blue** = key idea · **orange** = interview tip · **red** = common mistake · **green** = a line you can say.
- Numbers come from SJP's own reports (2025 annual results, 2026 half-year results) unless marked **"press"** (news report) or **"≈"** (rounded or estimated).

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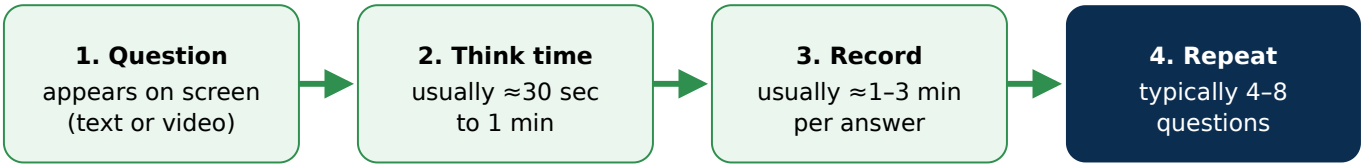
PART 4 · REVISION
60-second summary · Glossary

Prepared 6 November 2026. Facts can change; check sjp.co.uk news and the share price the week of your interview.

PART 1 · HIREVUE · 1 of 3

What to expect in the HireVue

A **HireVue** is a **one-way recorded video interview**. No person is on the call. A question appears on screen, you get some time to think, then you record your answer to the webcam. Recruiters watch the recordings later.



Timings vary by employer. Your invite and the practice question will show SJP's exact settings.

WHAT PAST SJP CANDIDATES REPORT (GLASSDOOR, ANONYMOUS, MOSTLY OLDER)

- One described **four questions with one minute to prepare each**.
- Reported questions included: *"Why do you want to work in wealth management and at SJP?"*, *"What excites you about SJP?"*, *"How does SJP make money?"*, *"Tell us about a time you made a mistake and what you learned"*, *"How have you shown leadership?"* and *"What is your greatest weakness?"*.
- Candidate tip: **"Know the company and why you want to work there."**

How to structure every answer

For "Why…?" / business questions: 3-point answer

1. Headline (one sentence answer) → **2. Two or three reasons**, each with one specific SJP fact → **3. Link back to you** and the role.

For "Tell us about a time…": STAR

Situation (1 line) → **T**ask (1 line) → **A**ction (most of your time: what *you* did) → **R**esult (a number if possible, plus what you learned).

Practical checklist

- ✔ Do the **practice question** first to test camera and sound
- ✔ Camera at **eye level**, light in front of you, plain background
- ✔ Look at the **camera**, not the screen
- ✔ Keep a **sticky note** of 3–4 SJP facts beside the camera
- ✔ Aim for **≈60–90 seconds** unless told otherwise
- ✔ Smile, slow down, and **finish on a clear last line**

DON'T

Read from a script (it shows), use jargon you can't explain, or run out the clock without reaching your point. Headline first.

PART 1 · HIREVUE · 2 of 3

Question bank: motivation and commercial awareness

These are the most likely questions. For each one: **what they're really testing**, and **the angle to take**. Page numbers point to where the facts are in this guide.

Question	What they're testing	Your angle (fill in with your own story)
Why St. James's Place?	Have you researched *us*, not just "finance"?	UK's largest advice business (≈£240bn, 1m+ clients, ≈5,000 Partners). Its unique Partnership life-cycle (Academy → BSP). Joining at the start of the "Amplify" growth phase in 2027. Pick one thing you genuinely find fascinating (see "Ten fascinating things").
Why wealth management?	Do you understand what WM is, and do you care about clients?	It's about real people's life decisions: retirement, family, inheritance. Mention a personal link if you have one (family, part-time job). Advice gap: many people need help and don't get it.
Why this graduate programme?	Do you know it's head office, not advising?	Rotations give a view of the whole advice system. The Level 4 Diploma gives technical depth. Data, projects and the CEO Office let you shape how ≈5,000 advisers work. **Don't** say "I want to be an adviser".
What do you know about SJP? / How does SJP make money?	Commercial awareness	Vertically integrated: advice + products + funds. Earns yearly % fees on money looked after (≈1.6–1.7% all-in for clients; SJP keeps ≈0.45%). Pensions are 55% of the money. Profit = money × margin − costs. Retention ≈95% is what makes it work.
What challenges does SJP / the industry face?	Balanced, mature thinking	(1) Turning strong gross inflows into stronger *net* inflows. (2) Fee pressure after the 2025 fee change, plus low-cost rivals. (3) AI and "targeted support" at the cheaper end. (4) Keeping and attracting top advisers. Close with an opportunity: pensions entering inheritance tax from 2027.
Tell us about a recent news story about SJP or the industry.	Do you follow the market?	Q3 2026 update (net inflows slowed to £0.57bn, record £242bn). SJP's AI tools (Advice Assistant, SOFI). NatWest buying Evelyn Partners. Pensions entering IHT in April 2027. Give the fact, then **why it matters**.
What do you think of SJP's fee change / the controversy?	Can you discuss a sensitive topic calmly?	What happened (exit fees, £426m refund provision) → what SJP changed (clear tiered fees, no exit fees on new money, refunds nearly done) → what's next (proving value under Consumer Duty). Fair and factual, about 20 seconds.
Who are SJP's competitors, and what makes SJP different?	Market understanding	Quilter (closest), Rathbones/Evelyn (investment managers), AJ Bell/Hargreaves (DIY). SJP's edge: scale of the Partnership, the Academy, BSP succession market, advice guarantee, AI at scale.
Where do you see yourself in 5 years?	Commitment to *this* path	Level 4 qualified, specialising in an area of the WM division (proposition, data, strategy), having delivered projects that helped Partners and clients.

PART 1 · HIREVUE · 3 of 3

Question bank: competency and curveballs

Each competency question maps to a line in the job description. Prepare **4–5 stories** from your life (uni, work, societies, sport) that you can reuse across these.

Question	Job description link	What a strong answer shows
Tell us about a time you used **data** to solve a problem or make a decision.	"Analyse data and produce insights"	A real dataset, the tool you used (Excel etc.), the insight, the recommendation, and the result in numbers.
Describe a time you **explained something complex** to someone without your knowledge.	"Excellent communication"; reports for senior leaders	You adapted to your audience, used simple language or visuals, and checked they understood.
Tell us about a time you **managed competing priorities**.	"Manage competing priorities... fast-paced"	How you ranked tasks (urgent vs important), communicated early, and delivered both.
Tell us about a time you **took initiative** / showed leadership.	"Show initiative... take ownership"	You spotted something nobody asked you to fix, acted, and others followed.
Describe a time you had to **adapt to change**.	"Adaptability"; rotating teams	A change you didn't choose, how you got up to speed fast, and what you'd do the same next time.
Tell us about a time you **built a relationship** or worked in a team.	"Relationship-building"; working with Partners	Understanding the other person's needs, building trust, and a shared result.
Tell us about a **mistake** and what you learned. / Your greatest **weakness**?	Self-awareness, "willingness to learn"	A real (not disastrous) mistake, ownership, and a concrete change you made since.

Possible curveballs (good to have a 30-second view on)

"Will AI replace financial advisers?"

Not the relationship. AI takes the admin. SJP's tools save ≈90 min per case (Advice Assistant), and SJP says pilot firms using SOFI grew new clients faster. Complex, emotional decisions still need people.

"How would you explain an ISA / pension to a client?"

ISA = a box where up to £20k a year grows tax-free and you can take it out any time. Pension = a box for retirement: the government tops up your savings with tax relief, but you can't touch it until your late 50s.

"What does good client outcome mean?"

Consumer Duty: the client gets a product that fits, at fair value, understands it, and gets support. And the firm can **prove** it.

"If you could change one thing at SJP…"

Example: use data to spot clients likely to leave early and prompt a Partner review, which attacks the "leaky bucket" (net inflows).

YOUR STORY BANK

Write 5 stories on a page: **data** · **teamwork** · **leadership/initiative** · **pressure/priorities** · **mistake/learning**. Most questions can be answered with one of these.

PART 2 · THE BASIC IDEA

Why do people pay someone to help with their money?

Imagine you're 58. You have £300,000 spread across three old work pensions, an ISA and some savings. You want to retire at 62. You have questions like these:



Most people don't have the time or knowledge to answer these themselves, and a mistake is expensive. So they pay a **financial adviser**, a qualified professional who looks at their whole situation and tells them what to do.

> **KEY IDEA**
> Advisers are usually paid a **small percentage of the money** they look after, every year. For example, 0.8% of £300,000 is £2,400 a year. So the more money a client has, the more the adviser earns. That one fact explains a lot of how SJP works.

Three ways people can manage their money

1. Do it yourself

Use an app or website to pick your own investments. Cheap, but you make all the decisions. *Example: AJ Bell, Hargreaves Lansdown.*

2. Get advice

A person plans your finances and recommends what to do. Costs more, but you get expertise and someone to call. *Example: **SJP**.*

3. Hand it over completely

A manager makes all the investment decisions for you. Usually for wealthier people. *Example: Rathbones.*

SJP is firmly in option 2. Its whole business is built around advisers giving advice.

PART 2 · VOCABULARY

The ten words you need

Learn these ten and you'll understand 90% of any conversation about SJP.

1. Wealth management

Helping individuals plan and look after their money over their whole life.

2. Financial adviser

A qualified person who recommends what to do with your money. At SJP they're called **Partners**.

3. FUM (Funds Under Management)

The total money a firm looks after for its clients. SJP's is about **£240 billion**.

4. Fund

A big pot where many people's money is pooled and invested in shares, bonds and so on by a professional manager.

5. Wrapper

The "box" your investments sit in, which decides the tax rules. Examples: **pension**, **ISA**, **investment bond**.

6. Pension

A wrapper for retirement savings. You get tax relief going in, but can't take the money out until your mid-50s.

7. ISA

A wrapper where up to £20,000 a year can be invested and grow tax-free.

8. Inflows / outflows

Gross inflows = new money coming in. **Net inflows** = new money in *minus* money taken out.

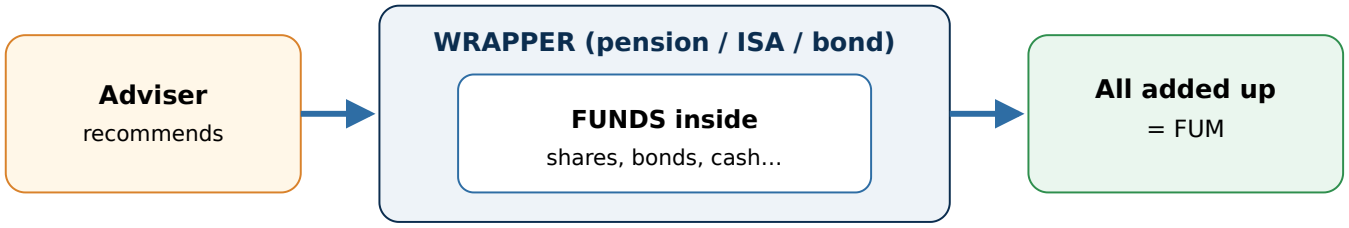
9. Retention

The share of money that stays with the firm each year. SJP keeps about **95%**.

10. FCA

The Financial Conduct Authority, the UK regulator that sets the rules for how firms treat customers.

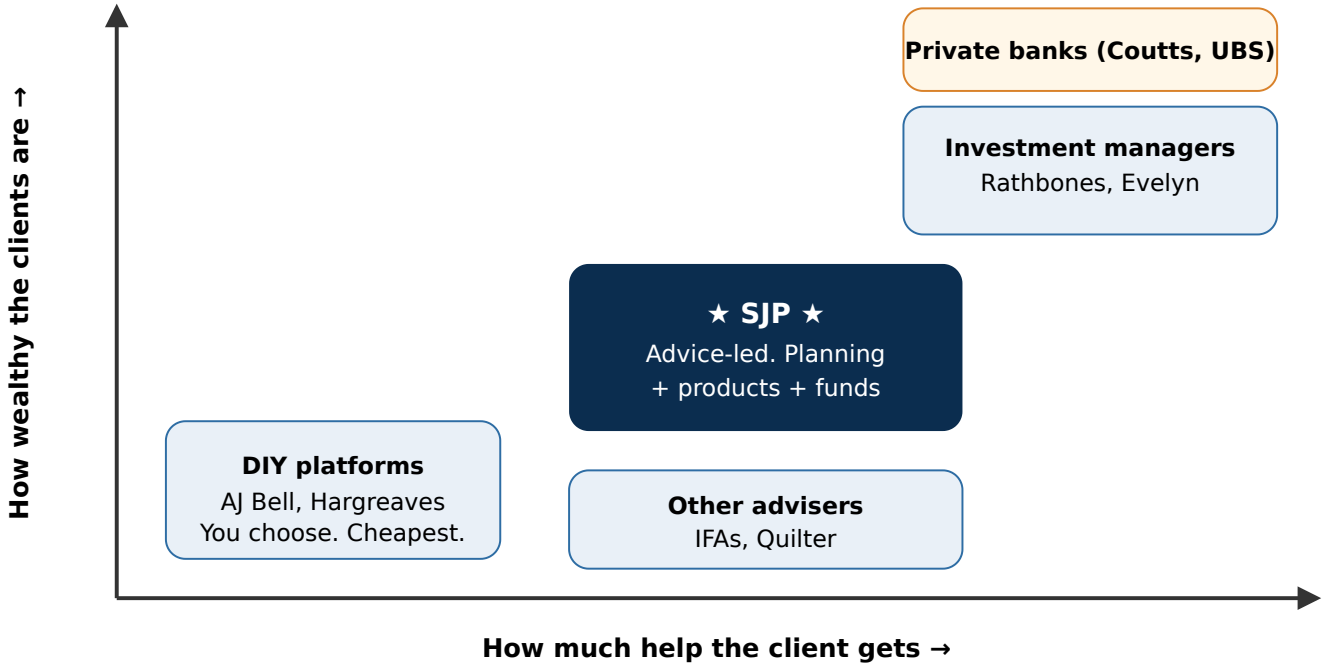
How the words fit together



PART 2 · THE LANDSCAPE

The different kinds of "money firm"

"Wealth management" covers several different businesses. This map shows where SJP sits.



Type of firm	What it does	Example
Financial adviser	Plans your whole financial life and recommends what to do	**SJP**, Quilter, local IFAs
Investment manager	Runs your investment portfolio for you	Rathbones, Evelyn
DIY platform	An app or website where you invest yourself	AJ Bell, Hargreaves Lansdown
Private bank	Banking, loans and investing for the very rich (often £10m+)	Coutts, JP Morgan, UBS
Asset manager	*Makes* funds and sells them to millions of investors; doesn't advise individuals	BlackRock, Schroders

COMMON MISTAKE

SJP is **not** a private bank and does **not** mainly serve the super-rich. Its typical client is comfortably off (≈£226k invested with SJP on average), not a multi-millionaire.

PART 2 · THE FIRM

What is St. James's Place?

In one sentence: SJP is the UK's **biggest financial advice business**. It **also owns the products and funds** its advisers recommend, and makes money by taking a **small yearly percentage** of every pound it looks after.

£240bn money looked after (FUM), mid-2026	**1.06m** clients	**≈5,000** advisers ("Partners")
≈£226k average invested per client	**≈95%** of money stays each year	**£462m** profit in 2025

An easy way to picture it: a franchise

Think of a coffee chain where each café is run by its own owner, but uses the chain's name, coffee and systems. SJP works in a similar way:

Coffee chain (analogy)
- Café owner runs their own shop
- Uses the chain's brand and coffee
- Head office supplies systems and rules

→

St. James's Place
- Partner runs their own advice business
- Uses SJP's brand, products and funds
- Head office supplies tools and checks

The analogy isn't exact (SJP isn't legally a franchise), but it's a good way to picture the set-up.

Why SJP is unusual: it owns every layer

With most advisers, the client pays several different companies. At SJP, one company owns them all. This is called **vertical integration**.

Typical adviser: 4 different firms

- Advice: Adviser firm A
- Wrapper: Provider B
- Admin platform: Platform C
- Funds: Fund house D

SJP: one firm owns all 4

St. James's Place

Advice ✓
Wrapper ✓
Admin (outsourced, SJP pays) ✓
Funds ✓

WHY THIS MATTERS

SJP earns a slice at **every** layer, and clients find it harder to leave. The downside: SJP advisers mainly recommend SJP's own products. This is called **"restricted" advice**, as opposed to "independent" advice, which can recommend anything on the market.

PART 2 · THE FIRM

A short history of SJP (1991 → today)

SJP is only about 35 years old. It grew from a start-up into a FTSE 100 company by building a huge network of advisers.

1991	**Founded** as J. Rothschild Assurance by Sir Mark Weinberg, Mike Wilson & Lord (Jacob) Rothschild
1992	Starts trading. Business Sale & Purchase (adviser succession) scheme begins
1997	Listed on the stock market via St. James's Place Capital; joins the FTSE 250
2000	Halifax buys 60% (later HBOS, then Lloyds Banking Group)
2002	Outsources administration to tech firm SS&C (still its back office, on the Bluedoor platform)
2006	Renamed simply "St. James's Place"
2012	Launches the **Financial Adviser Academy** to train its own advisers
2013	Lloyds sells its last shares. SJP becomes fully independent. (Also: RDR bans commission across the indus
2014	Joins the **FTSE 100**; enters Asia by buying The Henley Group
2016	Buys **Rowan Dartington**: adds bespoke portfolio management and stockbroking
2022	Launches **Polaris**, which becomes the UK's largest multi-asset fund range by 2024 (press)
2023–24	Fee criticism; Dubai office opens; new CEO Mark FitzPatrick; £426m refund provision; shares fall
2025	New simple fee structure (Aug); Polaris Multi-Index launched; record £220bn
2026–27	Record £242bn; 20+ AI tools; 5,000th BSP deal; "Amplify" growth phase from 2027

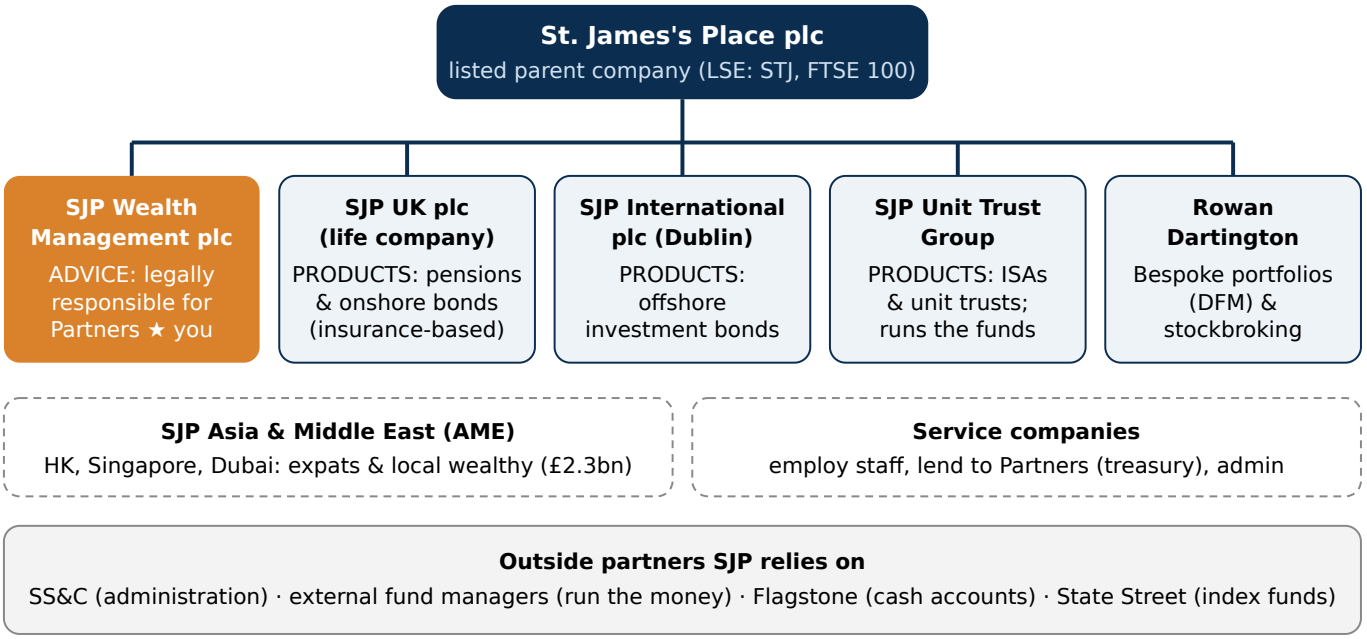
WHY THE FOUNDERS MATTER

Sir Mark Weinberg had already built two big UK savings firms (Abbey Life and Allied Dunbar) using large teams of advisers. SJP was his third version of the idea, and the "Partnership" of self-employed advisers comes from that playbook. (Founders and dates: SJP's heritage page. Weinberg background: general knowledge, so verify if you quote it.)

PART 2 · THE FIRM

How the group is structured

SJP is one listed company that owns a set of smaller companies, each with a job. You don't need to memorise the legal names. Understand the **jobs**.



Legal entity names come from SJP filings and company directories. The exact ownership chain is simplified here.

Who runs it: the leadership teams

Area	Leader	Job, in one line
Group	Mark FitzPatrick, CEO (since Dec 2023)	Runs the whole company; set the Strengthen → Amplify strategy
Finance	Caroline Waddington, CFO	Money, results, shareholder returns, BSP scheme economics
Wealth Management (your division)	**James Rainbow, CEO** (joined 2025 from Schroders; press)	Supports and oversees the ≈5,000 Partners: advice, tools, proposition, client service
Investments	Justin Onuekwusi, CEO Investments (confirmed 2026)	Chooses and monitors fund managers; Polaris; asset allocation
Board	Paul Manduca, Chair	Oversees management on behalf of shareholders

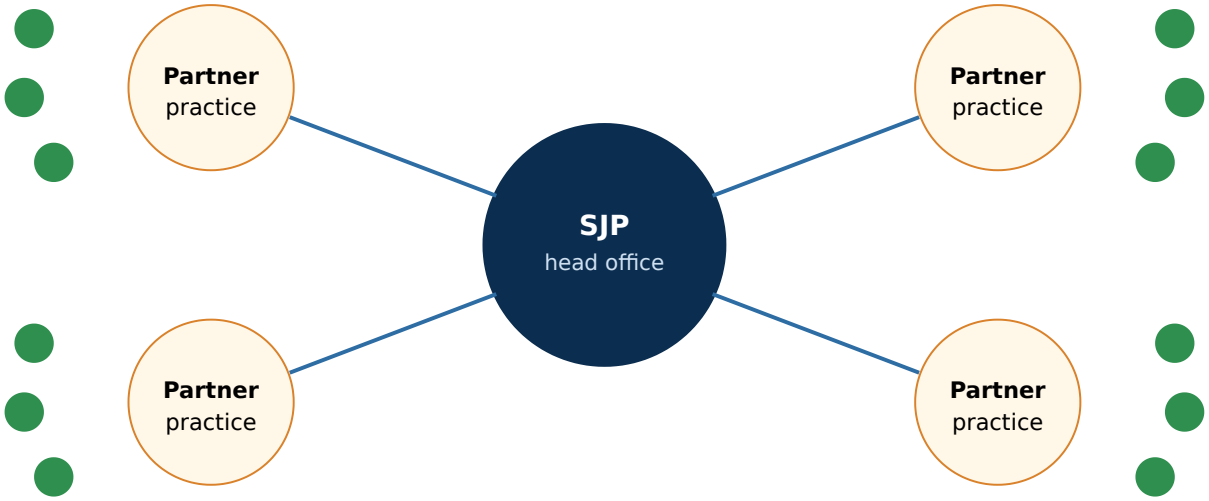
WHY A "LIFE COMPANY"?

Pensions and investment bonds are legally **insurance products**, so SJP owns an insurance company (SJP UK plc) to issue them. That's also why it's regulated by both the **FCA** (conduct) and the **PRA** (the Bank of England arm that checks insurers have enough capital).

PART 2 · THE ADVISERS

The Partnership: SJP's advisers

SJP's advisers mostly **don't work for SJP as employees**. They're self-employed business owners called **Partners**. Together they're known as "the Partnership".



Green dots = clients. ≈5,000 advisers, each looking after ≈215 clients and ≈£49m on average.

What the Partner does

Finds clients (mostly through referrals), gives the advice, and owns the relationship. Earns the advice fees. Can grow their business and eventually sell it.

What SJP head office does

Provides the brand, products, funds, technology and training. Checks the advice is good, because **SJP is legally responsible** for its Partners' advice in the regulator's eyes.

Where new advisers come from: the SJP Academy

SJP runs its own **Academy** that trains people, often career-changers, to become advisers. More than 89% of people who finish it are still at SJP three years later.

INTERVIEW TIP

Your graduate role is **not** in the Academy and you won't be a Partner. You'd be in head office, helping the Partners. Part 3 explains this.

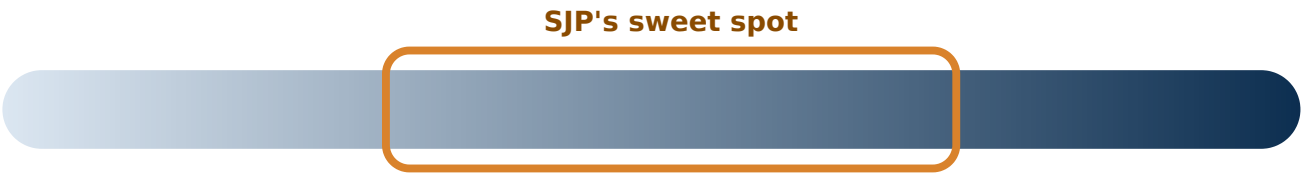
WHY THE MODEL WORKS, AND ITS WEAK SPOT

Partners are entrepreneurs, so they work hard to win and keep clients, and the business grows. But SJP is responsible for thousands of advisers it doesn't directly manage. That's where problems have come from (see "What went wrong").

PART 2 · CLIENTS

Who SJP's clients are, and why

SJP aims at the "**sweet spot**": people with enough money that advice pays for itself, but not so rich that they want a private bank.



Under ≈£50k
Too small: fees don't cover an adviser's time
→ apps, DIY platforms

≈£100k to a few £m
Enough to pay for advice; complex enough to need it
→ SJP

£10m+
Want loans, bespoke deals, lower fees
→ private banks

Meet three typical clients (made-up examples)

Sarah, 58

Owns a small company. Wants to sell it in 5 years and retire. Needs help taking money out tax-efficiently and planning her pension.

David & Priya, 66

Recently retired doctors. Want a steady income from their pensions and to help their children buy homes.

Tom, 45

Senior manager at a big firm. Has four old pensions and an ISA. Wants one clear plan and someone to call.

Why these clients make sense for SJP (the maths)

Client with £20k

0.8% = £160 a year

Client with £226k (average)

0.8% ≈ £1,800 a year

Average adviser (≈£49m)

≈£390k a year in fees

Advice takes hours of an expert's time. Only clients with a decent amount of money generate enough in fees to pay for it. That's why SJP focuses on the comfortably-off, and why its typical client is a **pre-retiree, retiree, professional or business owner** who arrives through a **referral** from a friend, an accountant or a solicitor.

PART 2 · CLIENTS

Who can be a client, and what's required?

There is **no official firm-wide minimum** to become an SJP client. In practice, the business is built for people with **tens of thousands to millions** to invest. Each Partner sets their own threshold.

What's required	The reality
Official minimum	None published. Product minimums are low: an SJP ISA can start from **£1,500** lump sum or **£150 a month** (SJP FAQ).
Adviser thresholds	Individual Partners often state minimums on adviser directories, e.g. **£50k+** or **£150k+** of investable wealth (press/directory listings; they vary).
Special services	Cash savings service (via Flagstone): from **£50k**. SJP's Asia arm has targeted clients with **US$1m+** (press).
How you join	Usually a **referral** or contact form → free first meeting → fact-find → advice → initial advice fee if you go ahead.
The real "requirement"	Enough money and complexity that ≈1.6–1.7% a year buys real value. Average client ≈**£226k** with SJP.

Clients by life stage: the main way to think about it

Builders
≈30–50

Growing income, family, mortgage

Needs: ISAs, pensions, protection

Pre-retirees ★
≈50–65

Peak wealth, many old pension pots

Needs: consolidate, plan retirement date

Retirees ★
≈65+

Living off savings (drawdown)

Needs: tax-efficient income, care planning

Passing it on
older clients & heirs

Family wealth moving generations

Needs: inheritance tax, trusts, gifting

★ = SJP's core. Pensions are 55% of SJP's money, which tells you most clients are approaching or in retirement.

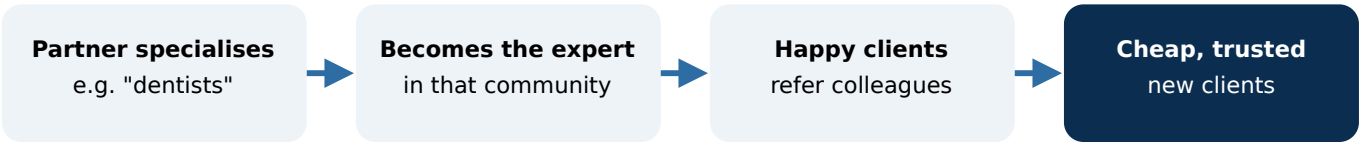
PART 2 · CLIENTS

Client types and industries SJP targets

Partners often **specialise** in a profession or industry. That makes them experts in its specific money problems and lets them win referrals inside that community.

Client type	Their specific money problem	How SJP helps
Business owners & company directors	Wealth is locked in the company; how to take money out tax-efficiently; selling the business	Profit extraction, company pension contributions, exit planning, protecting key people
Doctors, GPs, dentists (NHS)	Complex NHS pension rules, tax charges on large pensions, high incomes	Specialist NHS pension planning (several Partner practices advertise this)
Lawyers, accountants, professional partnerships	High, uneven incomes; partnership capital; retirement from the partnership	Tax planning, pensions, and these firms are also **referral sources** for SJP
Senior corporate employees	Share schemes, bonuses, many workplace pensions	Consolidation, using allowances, planning for share options
Farmers & rural families	Land-rich, cash-poor; passing on the farm; inheritance tax changes	Succession and inheritance planning (SJP has produced farm-business material)
Women investors	Career breaks, divorce, widowhood, often under-advised	SJP and Partners run "advice for women" propositions
Sports professionals	Big income over a short career	Making peak earnings last a lifetime
Private clients (wealthier)	Larger, more complex wealth	Bespoke portfolios via Rowan Dartington; a bigger HNW push planned under "Amplify"
Expats & international	Living abroad with UK ties	SJP Asia & Middle East (Hong Kong, Singapore, Dubai), offshore bonds
Businesses (as employers)	Want to help staff with money	Workplace financial education and group schemes (opens doors to future individual clients)

Segments drawn from SJP and Partner practice websites. Not every Partner offers every specialism.



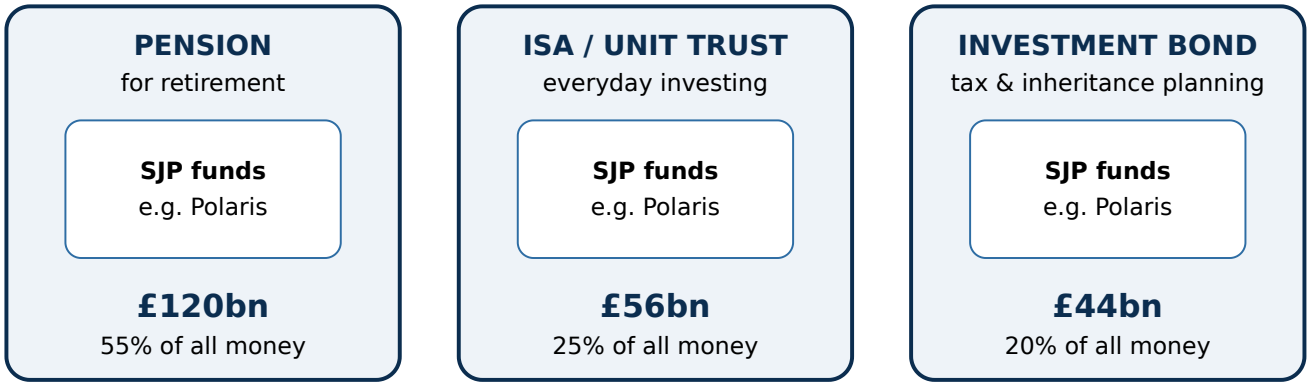
WHY IT WORKS

Advice is a **trust** purchase. People trust a recommendation from a colleague in their own profession more than any advert. Specialising turns each Partner into a referral engine.

PART 2 · PRODUCTS

What SJP sells: boxes, and what goes inside them

Every pound a client invests goes into a **box** (the wrapper, which sets the tax rules). Inside the box is a **fund** (where the money is actually invested). SJP owns both.



Figures at end-2025. The ISA/unit trust figure includes £3.7bn in bespoke portfolios run by managers for wealthier clients.

The funds: who actually invests the money?

SJP's investment team mostly **doesn't pick shares itself**. It **chooses outside expert fund managers**, gives each one part of the money to run, and checks their work. A useful picture is a **football manager picking players** rather than playing.

- **Polaris** is SJP's biggest fund range, at about **£94bn**. It comes in four risk levels, from cautious to adventurous.
- The money is spread around the world: about 38% in US and Canadian shares, 17% in bonds (loans to governments and companies), and the rest in Europe, Asia, the UK and cash.

Services: what the adviser helps with

Retirement
When can I stop work? How do I draw income?

Investing
Using ISA and pension allowances; choosing the right risk.

Inheritance
Passing money on, trusts, inheritance tax.

Protection
Life cover, illness cover, income protection.

Business owners
Taking money out of a company; planning a sale.

Mortgages and wills
Arranged through separate partner firms, not SJP itself.

PART 2 · PRODUCTS

Every product: why it exists, who it's for, SJP vs rivals

Product	Why it exists (the problem it solves)	Typical SJP client	SJP's version	How it differs from competitors
Pension (personal pension, SIPP, drawdown)	The government gives tax relief to encourage retirement saving. Since 2015 retirees can keep it invested and draw income.	50–70 year olds with several old pots	SJP pension (Retirement Account) invested in SJP funds, e.g. Polaris. £120bn	Rivals: DIY SIPPs (AJ Bell ≈0.25% platform fee) or IFA + platform. SJP bundles advice + wrapper + funds in one place, at ≈1.67% a year all-in.
ISA	£20k a year can grow tax-free; flexible access	Almost everyone with savings	SJP ISA, from £1,500 lump sum	The same ISA is available almost anywhere; SJP's difference is the advice and fund range. Total ≈1.59% a year in Polaris.
Unit trust (general account)	Investing beyond ISA and pension limits	Wealthier clients who've used their allowances	SJP unit trusts (the funds themselves)	Similar to any fund account; taxable.
Investment bond (onshore & offshore)	An insurance-based wrapper: tax is **deferred**, 5% a year can be withdrawn without immediate tax, and it works well in **trusts** for inheritance planning	Wealthy clients, retirees, inheritance planners	Issued by SJP's own life companies (UK & Dublin). £44bn	**Less common at DIY platforms**, so this is a genuine advice-led product. Owning a life company lets SJP offer it in-house.
Discretionary portfolios (DFM)	A manager makes buy/sell decisions on a bespoke portfolio	Wealthier private clients	Rowan Dartington. ≈£3.7bn	Competes with Rathbones, Evelyn, Quilter Cheviot; small for SJP.
Cash savings	Earning interest on cash awaiting investment, or as an emergency pot	Clients holding large cash	Via partner Flagstone, from £50k; cash ISAs too	Keeps the client's cash "inside" the SJP relationship.
Protection	Pays out if you die, fall ill or can't work	Families, business owners	Life cover, critical illness, income protection	Standard market products; an add-on to holistic advice.
Mortgages & wills	Buying property; who inherits what	Families	Through **separate firms**, not SJP itself	Rounds out the "whole of life" service.

The funds inside the products

Polaris (2022): four ready-made portfolios from cautious (1) to adventurous (4), ≈£94bn. In 2024 it overtook Vanguard LifeStrategy as the UK's largest multi-asset range (City AM). **Polaris Multi-Index (2025):** a cheaper index-based version (≈0.2% fund charge, press), built with State Street, >£1bn. **Single-strategy funds**, e.g. Global Smaller Companies (£1.9bn), are run by outside managers SJP hires and replaces.

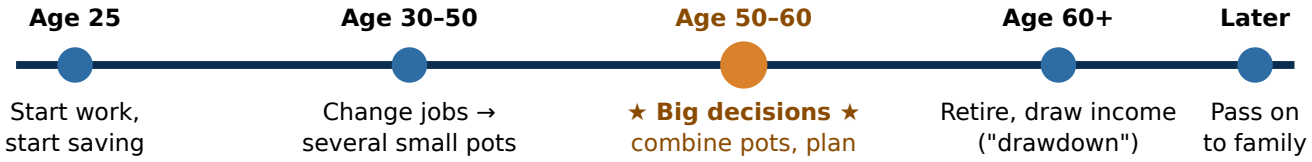
Fair comparison: critics compare SJP's ≈1.6–1.7% with Vanguard LifeStrategy's ≈0.22%, but that compares advice + wrapper + fund with a fund alone. The real question is whether the advice is worth the difference to that client.

PART 2 · THE BIG ONE

Why pensions matter so much

Pensions are **55% of SJP's money** and **63% of its new money** (2025). If you remember one product, remember pensions.

A pension over a lifetime



The orange point is where most people look for an adviser, which is why SJP's clients skew 45–70+.

Four reasons pensions are so important to SJP

1. Retirement got complicated

Since 2015, retirees can keep their pension invested and draw from it ("drawdown") instead of buying a fixed income for life. That means ongoing decisions, so people want advice.

2. People have lots of small pots

Combining old workplace pensions into one is a common, valuable piece of advice.

3. Tax

Pensions get tax relief. **From April 2027, unused pensions will count for inheritance tax**. That's a big change, and it creates more need for advice.

4. Money stays for decades

Only ≈4% of pension money leaves SJP each year, against ≈7% for ISAs and unit trusts. Long-lasting money means long-lasting fees.

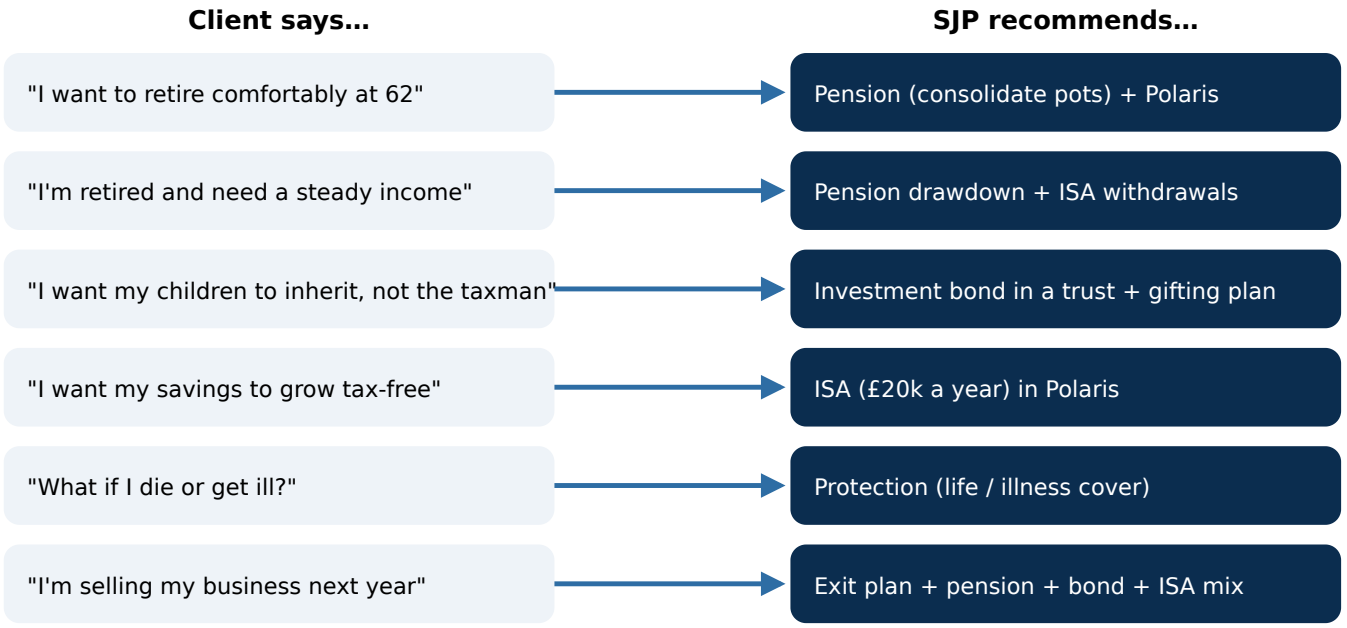
SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"Pensions are over half of SJP's money, and the 2027 inheritance tax change makes retirement planning even more complex. That's a tailwind for advice."

PART 2 · PRODUCTS

Why these products, for these clients?

Each SJP product answers a specific life need. The adviser's job is to match the need to the box.



Why SJP sells *its own* products (the business logic)

For SJP

Owning the box and the fund means SJP earns a fee at **every layer**, not just for the advice. Money in its own products is also easier to keep.

For the adviser

One joined-up system: paperwork, research, fund choice and compliance are done for them, so they can spend more time with clients.

For the client

One relationship, one statement, one place for everything, and a FTSE 100 firm standing behind the advice.

The trade-off

"Restricted" advice: the client isn't shown the whole market. This is why fees and value are scrutinised so closely under Consumer Duty.

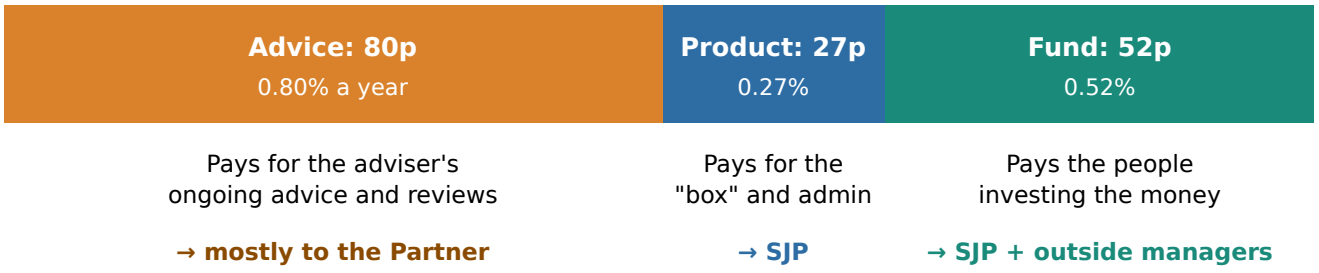
PART 2 · FEES

What a client pays

Since **26 August 2025**, SJP's fees are split into clear parts. There's a one-off fee at the start, then three yearly fees.

Every £100 invested: the yearly cost

Yearly cost on £100 (ISA in a typical Polaris fund) = £1.59



For a pension, the product fee is 0.35%, so the total is ≈1.67%. Fund fees vary by fund; 0.52% is SJP's own example.

Plus a one-off fee at the start (the "initial advice charge")

Part of the money invested	Fee
First £250,000	3%
Next £250,000	2%
Anything above £500,000	1%
Maximum £30,000. This mostly goes to the Partner.	

Worked example: £500,000 into an ISA

£12,500
one-off, at the start
(3% × £250k + 2% × £250k)

£7,950
every year after
(1.59% × £500k)

WHAT CHANGED IN 2025

Before August 2025, SJP's fees were bundled together and harder to see. Clients who left within six years could pay an **exit fee of up to 6%**. The new system shows each fee separately and has **no exit fee on new money**. "What went wrong" explains why.

PART 2 · THE MONEY

Is it fee-based or retention-based? Both, and here's why

SJP charges **fees** (a yearly % of the client's money). Because the fee repeats every year the money stays, **retention** is what turns those fees into a big profit. Fees are the price; retention is the multiplier.

How one £100,000 client is worth more the longer they stay



Illustration only: assumes SJP keeps ≈0.45% a year and the pot grows ≈4% a year after charges. Not SJP figures.

Why SJP charges this way

- **The law pushed it:** since 2013 (the RDR) advisers can't take commissions from product providers; they charge clients directly.
- **It's aligned:** if the client's money grows, SJP earns more. If it falls, SJP earns less.
- **It's predictable:** recurring income, like a subscription.
- **It scales:** one adviser can look after ≈£49m.

Why retention matters so much

- Winning a client costs time and money (initial advice, admin).
- The profit comes from the **years after**.
- SJP keeps ≈**95%** of money each year, so the average pound stays a long time.
- Pensions are the stickiest (≈4% leave a year), which is why they matter most.

Old model vs new model

	Before Aug 2025	After Aug 2025
Upfront cost	Hidden. SJP paid the adviser up front and recovered it over 6 years	Clear initial advice fee (3/2/1%, max £30k)
Leaving early	Exit fee up to 6% (bonds & pensions)	No exit fee on new money
When SJP earns	Mainly after year 6 ("gestation")	From day one, at a lower rate
Retention	Partly enforced by exit fees	Must be **earned** through good service

THE BIG SHIFT

The old model partly **locked** clients in. The new model has to **earn** retention through service and value. That's why the Wealth Management division (advice quality, client experience, Partner tools) is now so central.

PART 2 · PROFIT

How SJP makes its profit

SJP's profit is basically: **money looked after × the small slice SJP keeps − costs**.

Money looked after (£240bn) × **SJP's slice (≈0.45% a year)** − **Costs** = **Profit**

Where SJP's 2025 income came from



- **£725m** from yearly charges. The engine, and it repeats every year.
- **£100m** from new-business charges. Under the new fees this drops to ≈£0 from 2026.
- **£69m** interest on SJP's own cash.

After paying staff, offices, technology and other costs, SJP made **£462m profit** in 2025.

> **THE BIGGEST MONEY-MAKER**
> **Yearly percentage charges on client money**, and pensions most of all, because they're the biggest pile and stay the longest. It works like a subscription: once money is in, it pays SJP every year it stays.

The four levers that move profit

1. Stock markets ↑↓

If markets rise 10%, the money looked after rises, and so do the fees. In 2025, market growth added £23.6bn, nearly four times the £6.2bn of new money.

2. Net new money

Money coming in minus money leaving. Winning clients *and* keeping them.

3. The slice SJP keeps

It fell when fees were simplified in 2025, and is expected to creep back up as older money moves onto the new fees.

4. Costs

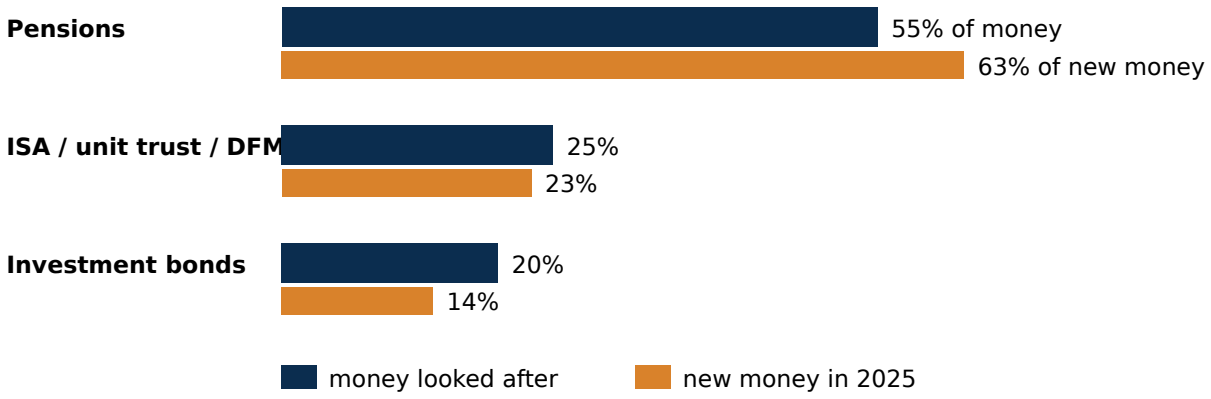
SJP is cutting ≈£100m of yearly costs by 2027.

PART 2 · THE MONEY

Which products make the most money?

SJP doesn't publish profit by product. But we can work it out from where the money sits, where new money goes, and how long it stays.

Share of money looked after vs share of new money (2025)



Rank (≈)	Product	Why
1	**Pensions**	Biggest pile (£120bn), most new money, and the **stickiest** (≈4% leaves a year). Most of the ≈£53bn "gestation" money moving onto full fees by ≈2031 is pensions and bonds, so profits from it should **rise**.
2	**Investment bonds**	£44bn, long-term, often in trusts (very sticky). Wealthier clients.
3	**ISAs / unit trusts**	£56bn, but the most likely to be withdrawn (≈7% a year), and a slightly lower product fee (0.27% vs 0.35%).
Small	DFM (Rowan Dartington) & Asia/Middle East	Still in "investment" mode: in 2025 both were small net **costs** in SJP's profit table (−£4.1m and −£7.6m).

And across the layers: who earns what



SJP's own net keep across product + fund layers: ≈**0.43–0.45%** of mature money a year (SJP guidance)

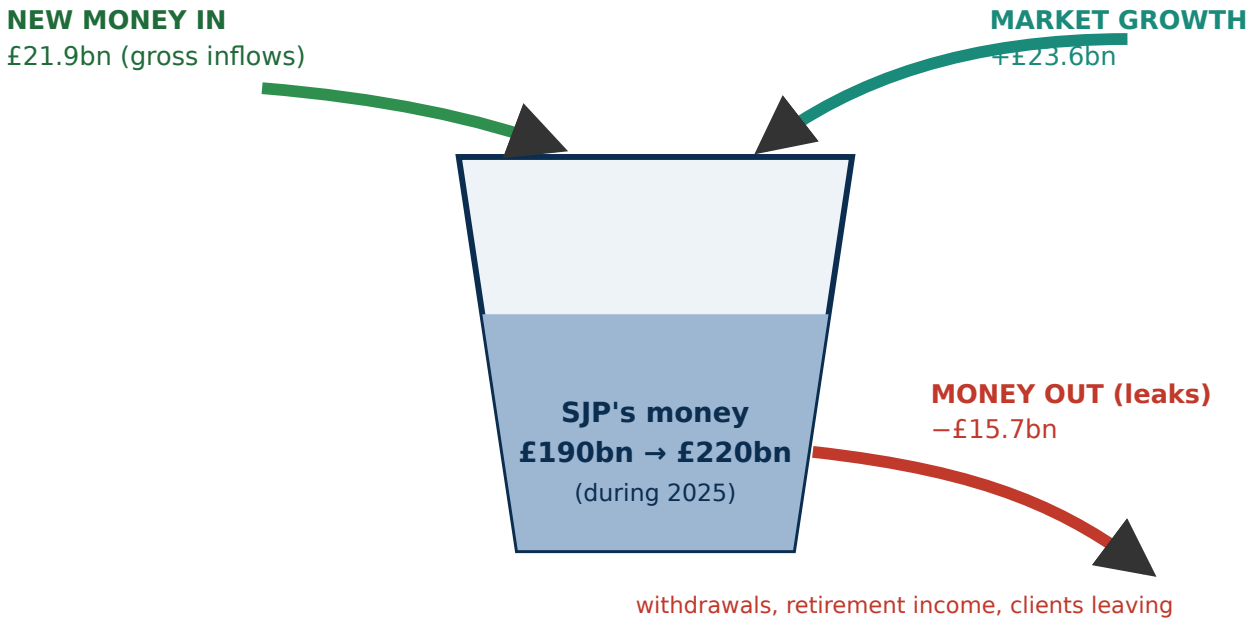
SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"Pensions are SJP's profit engine. They're over half the money, most of the new money, and the stickiest, and much of the older pension money is only now moving onto full charges."

PART 2 · THE KEY INSIGHT

The leaky bucket: money in and money out

This page is the smartest point you can make in an interview, so it's worth understanding well.



2025	Amount	What it means
Gross inflows	**£21.9bn**	New money invested. A record.
Money out	**−£15.7bn**	About 5% of the bucket leaks out each year (95% "retention")
Net inflows	**£6.2bn**	What's left after the leak, only ≈3% growth from new money
Market growth	**+£23.6bn**	Investments rising in value

WHY IT MATTERS

SJP is great at bringing money in. But with ≈5% leaking out every year, it needs **≈£11bn+ a year of new money just to stand still**. In 2026 net inflows slowed: £2.7bn in the first half, then just £0.57bn in July–September. Rivals like Quilter and AJ Bell are growing at about 9% a year from new money, against SJP's ≈2.5%.

Some leaking is natural: older clients take income in retirement, which is what the money was for. But it's the number analysts watch most closely.

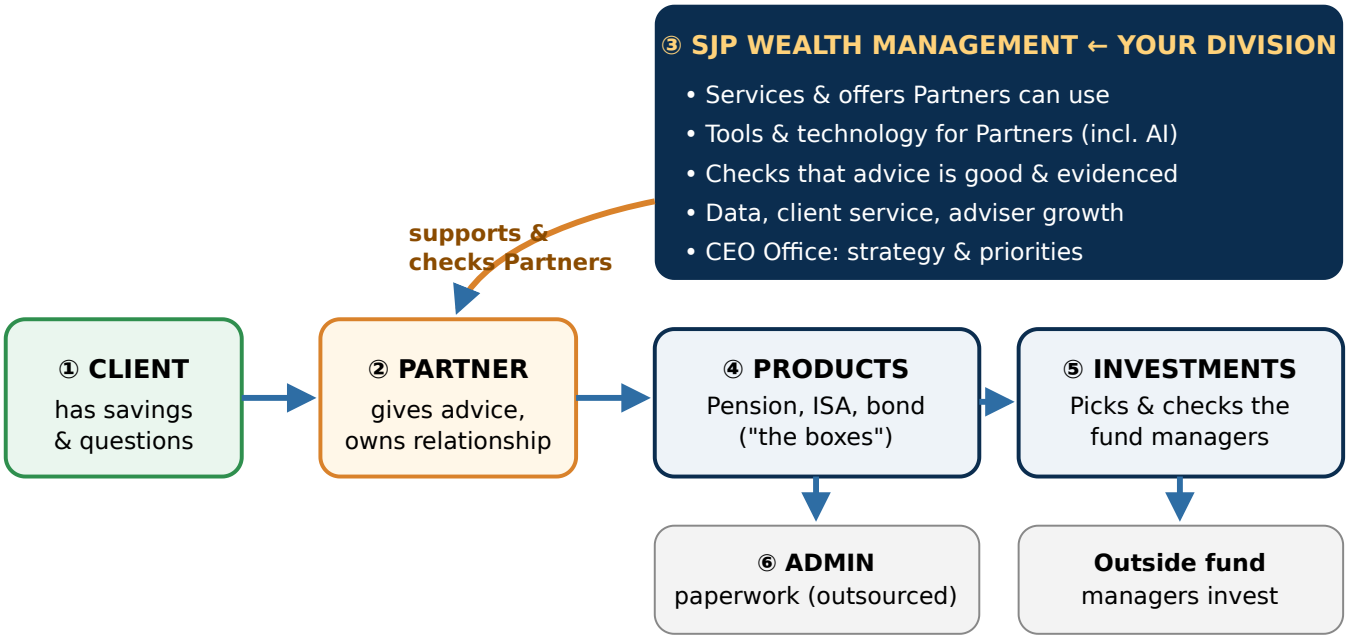
SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"SJP's gross inflows are strong, but with about 95% retention it needs over £11bn a year just to stand still. So the number I'd watch is **net** inflows."

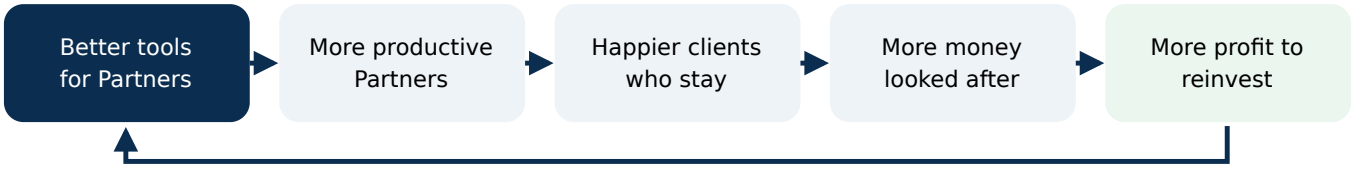
PART 2 · THE MACHINE

How all the parts work together

SJP is made of several teams that each do one job. Here's how they connect.



The cycle that keeps it growing



The Wealth Management division (where you'd work) sits at the **start** of this cycle.

PART 2 · THE JOURNEY

One client's journey, step by step

Let's follow **Sarah, 58, business owner**, through SJP, and see which part of the firm is involved at each step.

1. **Referral**
   Sarah's accountant recommends an SJP Partner. [Partner]

2. **Fact-find**
   The Partner learns everything: income, pensions, goals, how much risk she can take. [Partner, using SJP's tools and templates from Wealth Management]

3. **Plan & recommendation**
   A cashflow plan shows she can retire at 63. The Partner recommends combining 3 pensions into an SJP pension, yearly ISA top-ups, and an inheritance plan. Written up in a "suitability report". [Partner; advice checked by Wealth Management]

4. **Money moves in**
   Pensions transferred into an SJP pension (product). Paperwork done by the outsourced administrator. [Products + Admin]

5. **Money invested**
   Invested in Polaris, run by outside fund managers that SJP chose. [Investments]

6. **Every year: review & fees**
   The Partner reviews the plan each year. Sarah pays ≈1.6–1.7% a year. The review must be recorded as proof it happened. [Partner + Wealth Management + Finance]

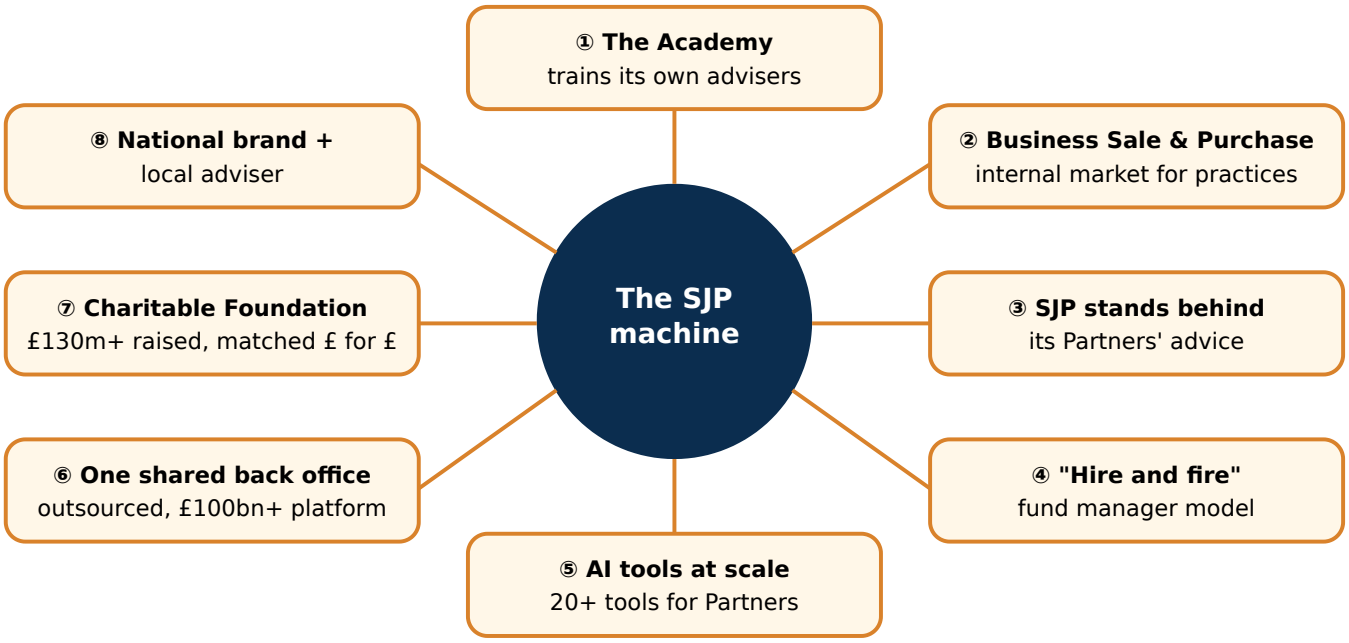
7. **She stays, adds more, and introduces her children → SJP grows.**

NOTICE

Wealth Management (your division) shows up at steps 2, 3 and 6, behind the scenes, making the Partner's job easier and making sure the advice is good.

What makes SJP different (beyond "we give good advice")

Every wealth firm says it has great advice and great people. These are the **specific systems** SJP has built that rivals mostly don't have, or don't have at this scale.



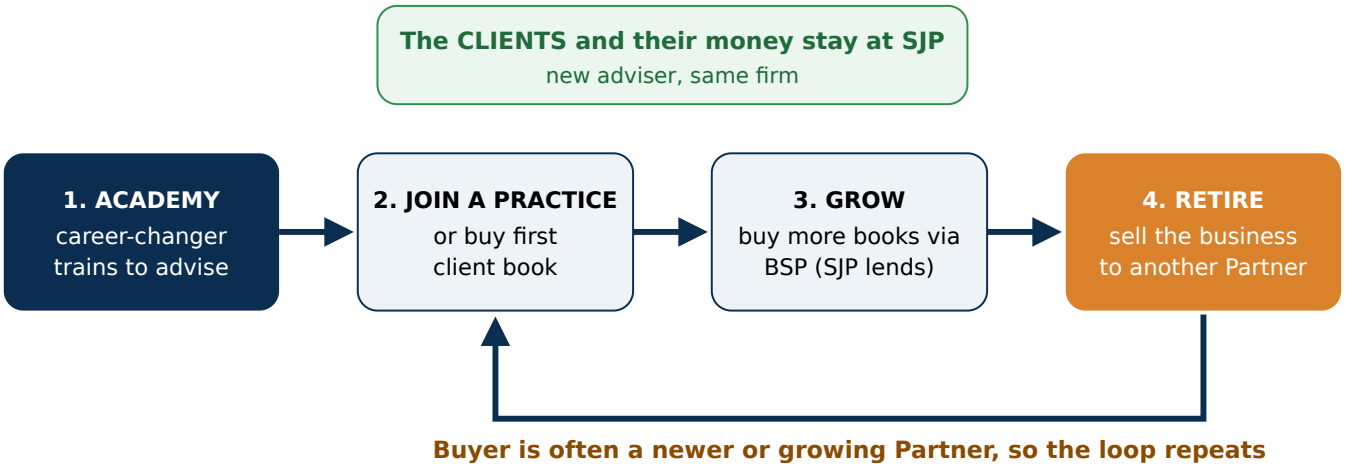
THE BIG IDEA THAT TIES THEM TOGETHER

Most advice firms are small and independent: one firm, a few advisers, and no plan for when the founder retires. SJP has built a **complete life-cycle system for advisers**. It **creates** them (Academy), **equips** them (tools, products, brand), **stands behind** them (guarantees their advice), and lets them **buy and sell** client books internally (BSP). So clients and their money stay inside SJP even when individual advisers come and go. That's a big reason retention stays around 95%.

Sources: mainly SJP's Half Year 2026 results presentation (July 2026) plus trade press (Money Marketing, Professional Adviser). Some figures are SJP's own claims; these are marked "SJP says".

The adviser life-cycle: the Academy and BSP

This is probably SJP's most distinctive piece of structure, and it's exactly the area your division supports.



① The SJP Academy (since 2012)

• Trains people, often career-changers, to become qualified advisers.
• **200** advisers graduated in Oct 2026; 175 in 2025.
• SJP says it trains **around half of all new advisers** entering the UK profession.
• 89%+ are still at SJP three years later.
Why it matters: the UK has an ageing adviser population. SJP *manufactures* its own replacements instead of competing for scarce experienced advisers.

② Business Sale & Purchase (BSP), since 1992

• An **internal marketplace** where Partners buy and sell client businesses.
• **5,000th** deal completed in March 2026.
• About **250–300 deals a year**, worth about **£200m** a year.
• H1 2026: nearly **200 advisers bought**, including SJP's **largest ever** BSP deal.
• SJP **lends Partners the money** to buy.
Why it matters: it gives a Partner's business a **sale value**, which makes them want to stay. And when they retire, clients pass to another SJP adviser instead of leaving.

WHY RIVALS FIND THIS HARD TO COPY

An independent adviser who retires usually sells to an outside buyer, often a private-equity-backed "consolidator", and clients may move platform or leave. At SJP the buyer is inside the system and SJP finances the deal. It's a **succession machine**, and it took 30+ years and a huge adviser base to build. The CFO called BSP "a critical part of what we offer our advisers… from recruitment to retirement".

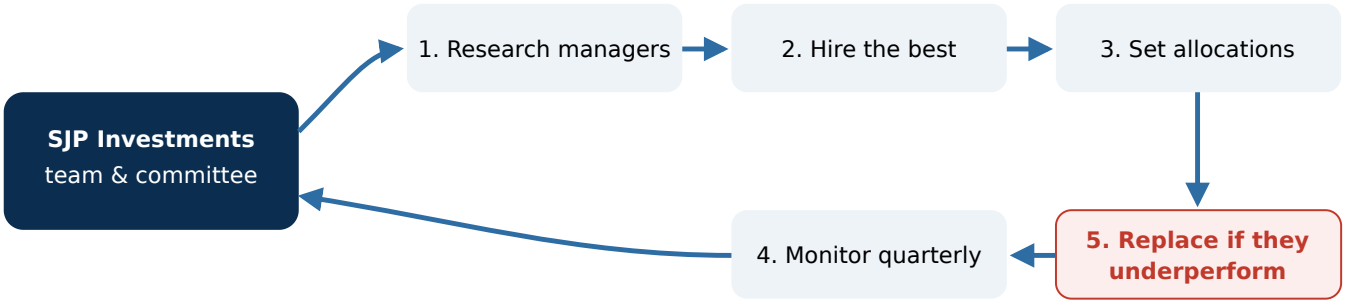
Investment model, advice guarantee, back office

③ SJP stands behind its Partners' advice

In SJP's own words (H1 2026): *"We guarantee their advice and provide the technical insights to help them understand and adapt their advice for changes in the tax, pension, regulatory and political landscape."*

Because SJP is the regulated "principal", **clients complain to SJP, and SJP pays any redress**. The £426m refund provision is the proof that this is real. A small independent adviser has to carry that risk alone, and its insurance may not cover it. For clients, it means a FTSE 100 company backs the advice. For advisers, it's protection plus a central technical team on tax and pension changes. **Your division runs much of this.**

④ The "hire and fire" fund manager model



SJP mostly **doesn't pick shares itself**. It acts like a **football manager**: it picks outside expert fund managers, gives each a slice of the money, and replaces them if they underperform. Clients never have to move their money, because the fund keeps its SJP name while the managers inside it change.

Real example (2025): SJP switched its £1.9bn Global Smaller Companies fund from one manager to **seven**, hiring six new managers alongside the existing one. For its new cheaper **Polaris Multi-Index** range (2025), State Street built 14 index funds, while SJP's in-house team sets the overall mix.

⑥ One shared back office

SJP outsources its administration to the technology firm **SS&C**, and has done since 2002. All products run on SS&C's **Bluedoor** platform, which handles **£100bn+**. Partners don't have to choose or pay for their own platform, compliance systems or fund research, as an independent adviser would. They plug into SJP's.

Note: the Bluedoor details come from SS&C/trade press coverage, around 2019. Check that the current set-up hasn't changed.

PART 2 · WHAT MAKES SJP DIFFERENT · 4 of 4

AI at scale, culture, and what's coming

⑤ AI tools: SJP's answer to the "AI will replace advisers" fear

After the February 2026 share sell-off over AI fears, SJP set out its position: *"far from being a threat to our model, we see AI as an enabler of it."* It says it has **more than 20 AI tools** in use. The three it named:

Tool	What it does	Result SJP reports
Advice Assistant	Drafts advice paperwork (e.g. suitability reports). Built with SS&C and intellectAI	Saves **≈90 minutes per case**
ChatSJP	An internal chatbot answering policy and advice questions for Partner practices, 24/7	**≈2,500** monthly users; ≈15 minutes saved per question
SOFI	"Meeting intelligence": automates note-taking and meeting admin	Pilot firms grew new clients faster than a control group, especially small practices. Now rolling out to all Partners

Why scale matters here: one SJP investment in a tool reaches ≈5,000 advisers at once. A small independent firm can't build or buy that. SJP's three AI principles are "human-centric AI", "ecosystem-led innovation" (partnering with tech firms) and "data as a strategic asset".

⑦ Culture: the Charitable Foundation

SJP's Foundation has raised **£130m+** since 1992. SJP **matches every £1** raised, and over **70%** of Partners and employees give monthly (2024 report). It was £9.7m in 2024 including the matching. That's unusual for a financial firm, and it's a big part of how SJP builds a shared identity across thousands of self-employed advisers.

⑧ National brand + local adviser

SJP calls this "the best of both worlds": a personal local adviser backed by a FTSE 100 brand. SJP says its **net promoter score** (how likely clients are to recommend it) and **brand awareness** have each risen **14 percentage points** since end-2023. In a business built on referrals, that matters.

Recent and upcoming initiatives to know

New Partner pay (2026)

Simpler adviser pay that rewards **high-quality, whole-of-life advice**, not just bringing in money. Funded through cost savings.

Wider product shelf

Polaris Multi-Index (cheaper, index-based) and a cash/cash-ISA service through partner firm **Flagstone**.

Wealthier clients (Amplify)

SJP says it will build more support for clients with "complex and substantial" wealth from 2027.

HOW TO USE THIS IN YOUR INTERVIEW

"What struck me is that SJP isn't just an advice firm. It's built a whole life-cycle for advisers: the Academy creates them, SJP backs their advice, and the Business Sale and Purchase market lets them build and sell businesses. So the clients stay inside SJP even when advisers retire. Now it's adding AI tools like Advice Assistant and SOFI across 5,000 advisers. That's scale a small firm can't match, and it's the kind of work the Wealth Management division drives."

PART 2 · REAL EXAMPLES

Real examples, "mandates" and news you can quote

WHAT'S A "MANDATE"?

A **mandate** is a formal instruction to a fund manager: "manage £X of our money, in this style, against this target". SJP's investment team **hands out mandates** to outside managers and takes them away if they disappoint. That's how its "hire and fire" model works.

When	What happened	Why it's interesting
2024 (press)	**Polaris overtakes Vanguard LifeStrategy** as the UK's largest multi-asset fund range	Shows the distribution power of 5,000 advisers. Critics noted it costs far more, and much of the money came from existing clients switching in.
2025	**Global Smaller Companies fund (£1.9bn)**: moved from one manager to **seven** (six new mandates alongside Northern Trust)	A textbook "hire and fire" decision: spreading the money across complementary styles.
2025	**Polaris Multi-Index** launched with State Street (14 index building blocks; ≈0.2% fund charge, press); >£1bn quickly	SJP responding to low-cost competition: a cheaper option inside its own system.
Aug 2025	**New fee structure** live after ≈2 years' work, costing £119m to implement	Biggest change in SJP's history; ended exit fees on new money.
2024–26	**Cash service with Flagstone**: minimum cut from £250k to £50k; cash ISAs added	Keeps clients' cash inside the relationship.
Mar 2026 (press)	**5,000th BSP deal**; ≈250–300 a year, ≈£200m a year	A 34-year-old internal market for adviser businesses.
H1 2026	**Largest BSP deal ever**; nearly 200 advisers buying	Succession is accelerating as older advisers retire.
H1 2026	**SOFI** AI meeting tool: pilot firms grew new clients faster than a control group; now rolling out	Evidence that AI helps advisers rather than replaces them.
H1 2026	**Brand:** net promoter score and awareness each up 14 points since end-2023	Reputation recovering after the 2024 crisis.
Oct 2026	**200 new advisers** graduate from the Academy	SJP says it trains ≈half of all new UK advisers.
29 Oct 2026	**Q3 update:** record £242bn, but net inflows only £0.57bn	The "leaky bucket" challenge in one number.

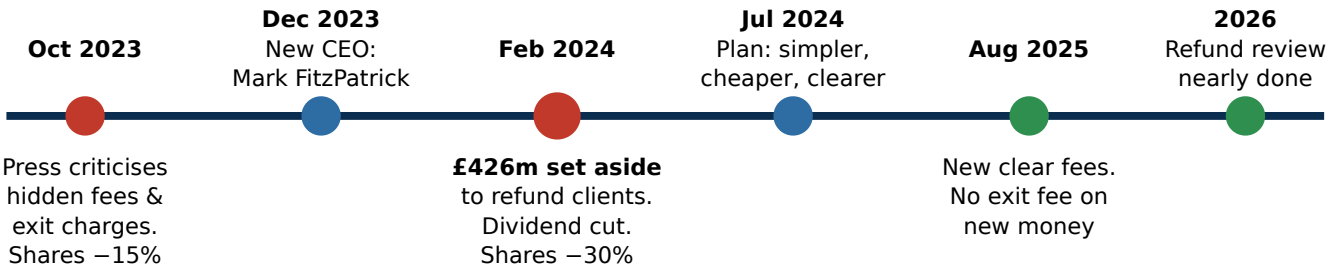
HOW TO USE A NEWS ITEM IN THE HIREVUE

Fact (one line) → **so what** for SJP → **link to the role**. Example: "SJP's SOFI pilot showed AI tools helping advisers win more clients. That's the kind of Partner-tool project the Wealth Management team runs, and I'd love to measure impact like that."

PART 2 · THE DIFFICULT PART

What went wrong, and how it was fixed

You **must** know this story. Interviewers expect you to know it, and to talk about it calmly and fairly.



Red = problem · Blue = response · Green = fix

Problem 1: the exit fee

Clients who moved their money out within 6 years paid up to **6%**. Critics said this **trapped** unhappy clients and hid the real cost. **Fixed:** scrapped for new money from Aug 2025. Older money still carries it until about 2031.

Problem 2: reviews not delivered

Clients paid a yearly fee for an annual review, but some couldn't be shown to have had one. In Feb 2024 SJP set aside **£426m** to refund them (covering fees back to 2018). **Now:** it needed less than expected; £110m was left in mid-2026 and the review should finish in 2026.

WHY IT CAME TO A HEAD: "CONSUMER DUTY"

New FCA rules from July 2023 changed the standard from *"did you tell the client?"* to *"is the client getting **fair value**, and can you **prove** it?"*. Bundled fees and unproven reviews didn't pass that test. Other firms (Quilter, Rathbones) have had similar ongoing-advice issues.

DON'T SAY

"The FCA fined SJP £426m." That's wrong. The £426m was SJP's **own** refund budget, not a fine.

SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"Consumer Duty raised the bar from disclosure to proving fair value. SJP responded by simplifying its fees, removing exit charges and refunding clients, and that review is nearly complete."

PART 2 · TODAY

What's happening now (late 2026)

SJP's strategy in two phases

"STRENGTHEN" (2024–2026)
Fix the basics: new fees, refunds, cut costs

→

"AMPLIFY" (2027 onwards)
Grow faster. ← You'd join in Sept 2027

The last 12 months in brief

When	What happened	Good or bad for SJP?
Feb 2026	Record 2025 results. SJP promises to return 70% of profit to shareholders	**Good**
Feb 2026	Shares fall sharply on fears that AI tools could replace advisers	**Worry**
Apr 2026	New FCA "targeted support" rules let firms give simpler, cheaper help to people who can't afford advice	**Mixed**
Jun 2026	NatWest bank buys the wealth manager Evelyn Partners: a new, bank-backed rival	**Competition**
Jul 2026	Record £240.8bn of money looked after; refund budget down to £110m; profit down as expected after the fee change	**Mostly good**
Oct 2026	Net new money slows to £0.57bn for July–September; shares dip	**Worry**
Apr 2027	Unused pensions start to count for inheritance tax	**More need for advice**

Who runs SJP

Mark FitzPatrick
Group Chief Executive (since Dec 2023)

James Rainbow
CEO of SJP Wealth Management, **your division** (joined 2025 from Schroders, per press reports)

Caroline Waddington
Chief Financial Officer

Paul Manduca
Chair of the Board

Check the share price and any news on SJP's website the week before your interview.

PART 2 · THE FUTURE

SJP's strategy: where it's going, and why

STRENGTHEN · 2024–2026

- ✔ New simple fees (Aug 2025)
- ✔ Refund review (finishing 2026)
- ✔ ≈£100m cost cut (by 2027)
- ✔ Polaris Multi-Index, cash, AI tools
- ✔ Shareholder payout raised to 70%

AMPLIFY · 2027 →

- → Grow faster: more clients, more advisers
- → More for wealthier (HNW) clients
- → Data & AI to boost adviser productivity
- → Stronger brand & Partnership community
- → Details due at Feb 2027 results

The targets SJP has set

2×
Double profit (Underlying cash result) from 2023 to 2030

£100m
a year of costs removed by 2027

70%
of profit returned to shareholders each year from 2026

Why SJP is doing this: the forces behind the strategy

1. Regulation (Consumer Duty)

Firms must prove fair value. Opaque fees and exit charges weren't sustainable, so SJP had to simplify first.

2. Competition

Cheap DIY platforms growing at ≈9% a year; banks buying wealth managers (NatWest–Evelyn). SJP needs to grow, not just stay big.

3. AI and technology

A threat (cheaper digital advice; Feb 2026 share sell-off) and an opportunity (20+ tools across 5,000 advisers). Scale lets SJP invest.

4. The advice gap and demographics

An ageing population, pension freedoms, and pensions entering inheritance tax in 2027 all increase demand for advice.

5. The adviser shortage

Advisers are getting older and rivals compete for them, so the Academy, BSP and new Partner pay become strategic weapons.

6. Profit maths

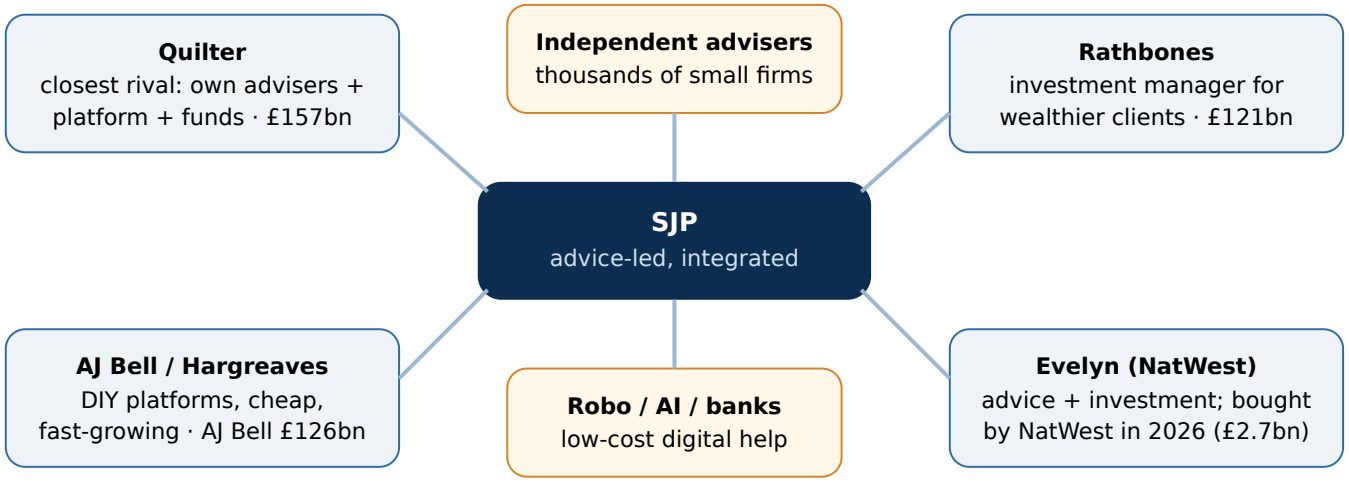
Lower margins after the fee change mean growth must come from volume, maturing older money, and cost discipline.

SOMETHING YOU CAN SAY

"SJP spent 2024–26 fixing its foundations, with transparent fees, refunds and lower costs. From 2027 it's moving to growth. Joining in September 2027 means arriving right at the start of that."

PART 2 · THE MARKET

Competitors: who SJP is up against



Firm	Model	New-money growth	Versus SJP
SJP	Restricted advice + own products + funds	≈2.5% a year (H1 2026)	Biggest adviser force; strongest retention system
Quilter	Own advisers + platform used by independent advisers + DFM	≈9% a year (H1 2026)	Wins money from independent advisers too; growing faster
Rathbones	Discretionary investment management	Outflows in H1 2026	Richer clients; investment-led rather than advice-led
AJ Bell	DIY / adviser platform	≈9% a year	Much cheaper, no personal advice; younger clients
Hargreaves Lansdown	DIY platform (private since 2025)	n/a (private)	Self-directed investors
Evelyn / NatWest	Bank-owned advice + investment	n/a	Can feed bank customers into advice

SJP'S EDGE IN ONE LINE

Distribution and loyalty: ≈5,000 advisers, an adviser "factory" (Academy), a succession market (BSP), and ≈95% retention. Its weak spot is **growth rate and price** against cheaper, faster-growing rivals.

PART 2 · PICK YOUR "HOOK"

Ten genuinely fascinating things about SJP

Recruiters hear "it's a great firm" all day. Pick **one** of these that you honestly find interesting and use it in "Why SJP?".

1. It builds its own advisers

SJP says its Academy trains ≈half of all new UK advisers. 200 graduated in Oct 2026.

2. It runs a marketplace for advice businesses

BSP: 5,000 deals since 1992, ≈£200m a year. Advisers can buy and sell client books, financed by SJP.

3. It's a fund giant without being a stock-picker

Polaris became the UK's biggest multi-asset range, but SJP mainly **hires and fires** outside managers.

4. It owns an insurance company

That's how it can issue pensions and investment bonds itself, products most advisers must buy from others.

5. It rebuilt its pricing from scratch

A ≈2-year, £119m project ended exit fees and made every charge visible, while keeping ≈95% retention.

6. AI as a helper, not a replacement

Advice Assistant saves ≈90 min per case; SOFI pilot firms won more new clients.

7. The money stays when advisers retire

Clients pass to another SJP Partner via BSP, so the firm keeps the relationship.

8. A charity built into the culture

£130m+ raised; SJP matches every £1; 70%+ of Partners and staff give monthly.

9. Profits are still to come from the past

≈£53bn of older money only reaches full charges over the next ~6 years, so earnings are "baked in".

10. A turnaround story

From a 30% share crash and £426m provision (2024) to record £242bn and a 70% payout (2026), now pivoting to growth.

EXAMPLE "WHY SJP?" OPENER

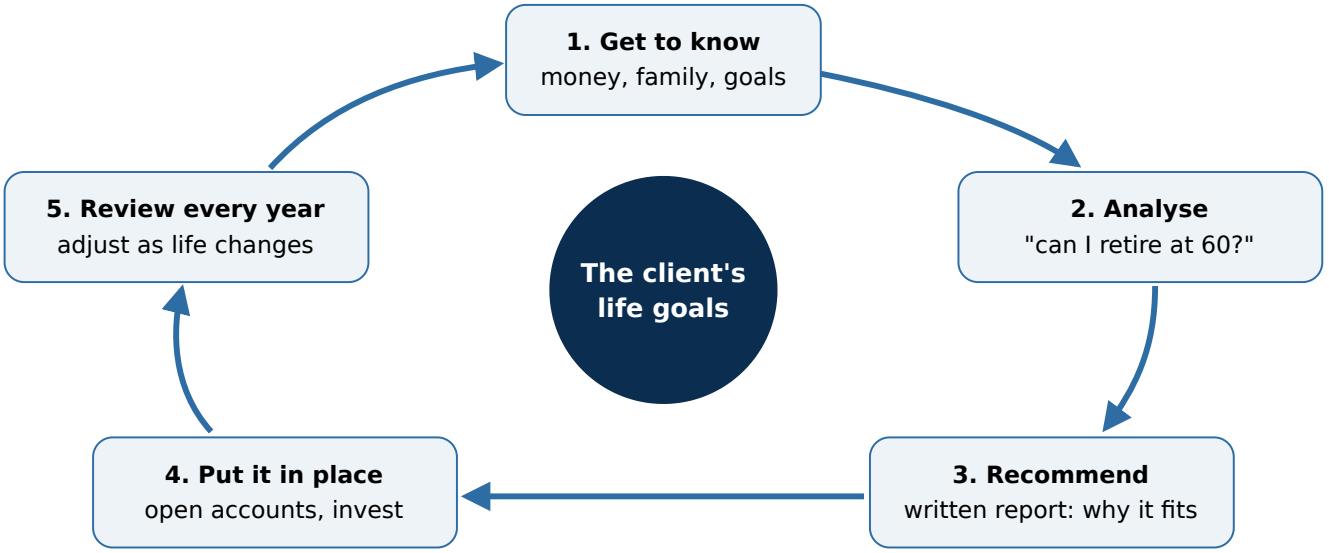
"What fascinates me about SJP is that it isn't just an advice firm. It's built a complete system around its advisers, from training them in the Academy to letting them buy and sell businesses through BSP, so clients stay even when advisers retire. I'd love to work in the division that runs that system."

PART 3 · THE INDUSTRY

What "wealth management" really means

Wealth management means **helping a person plan and look after their money across their whole life**: growing it, protecting it, drawing on it in retirement, and passing it on.

The advice cycle: what an adviser actually does



Wealth management vs asset management (people mix these up)

Wealth management

Serves **people**. Asks "what should *this person* do with their money?" Long relationships. **Example: SJP.**

Asset management

Makes **funds**. Asks "how do we make this fund perform?" Sells to millions; never meets most investors. **Example: BlackRock.**

SJP is mainly a **wealth manager**. It has an investment arm, but uses outside asset managers to run most of the money.

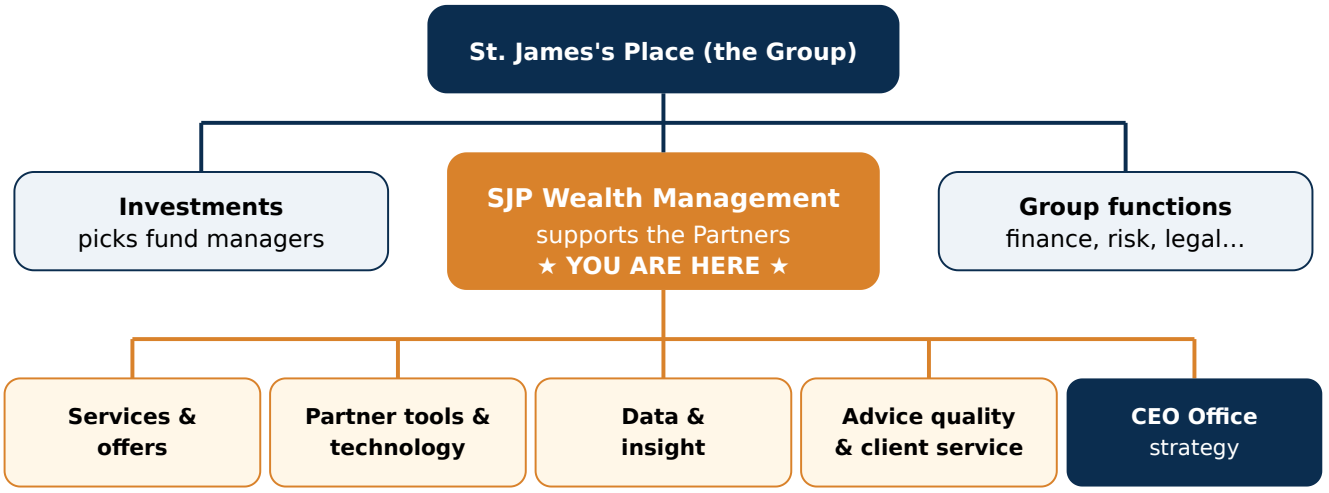
The rules of the game, in one line each

FCA	The regulator; sets the rules on treating customers fairly
Level 4 qualification	The exam level you need to give investment advice in the UK (you'll study for this)
Consumer Duty	Firms must deliver good outcomes and fair value, and prove it
Suitability	Advice must fit that specific client
Financial Ombudsman	Free service that settles customer complaints against firms
Restricted vs independent	Restricted (like SJP) recommends a limited range; independent can recommend anything on the market

PART 3 · YOUR JOB

Your job: where you'd sit

You'd work in **head office**, in the team that **supports the ≈5,000 Partners**. You won't be advising clients yourself. Your "customers" are mainly the **Partners**, and through them the clients.



Likely teams, based on the job description. SJP hasn't published the exact list, so ask about it in your interview.

The job description confirms you'll do projects in the Wealth Management "Chief Executive Office".

The facts from the job description

2 years
rotating through different teams

Permanent
job from day one; you stay in the division afterwards

Level 4
Diploma in Regulated Financial Planning, paid for and supported

London
Lombard Street office

3+ days
a week in the office (hybrid)

Sept 2027
start date

PART 3 · YOUR JOB

Your job: what you'd actually do

Your two years at a glance (illustrative)

Rotation 1	Rotation 2	Rotation 3	Rotation 4
e.g. Data & insight	e.g. Partner tools	e.g. Services/offers	e.g. CEO Office

Running alongside: studying for the Level 4 Diploma in Regulated Financial Planning

The number and order of rotations are a guess; ask SJP how it works.

What the job description says, and what it means in real life

Job description says…	…in real life (example task)
"Analyse data and produce insights"	Use Excel to find which types of client took the most money out this year, and explain why in a short summary
"Prepare reports and presentations for senior leaders"	Build 5 clear slides on how a new adviser tool is going, with a recommendation on page 1
"Projects that enhance the adviser and client experience"	Collect feedback from Partners on an AI note-taking tool and measure how much time it saves
"Support strategic initiatives"	Help plan how SJP supports clients when pensions enter inheritance tax in April 2027
"Build relationships across the business"	Work with Partners, compliance, investment and tech teams on one project
"Participate in projects within the CEO Office"	Track progress on the "Amplify" growth plan and prepare updates for the leadership team

The Level 4 Diploma, simply

This is the qualification UK advisers **must** have to give investment advice. It usually covers six topics:

- 📘 Rules & ethics of financial services
- 📘 Investments & risk
- 📘 Personal tax
- 📘 Pensions & retirement
- 📘 Protection (insurance)
- 📘 Putting it all into a financial plan

Based on the standard CII Diploma (DipPFS). The job description doesn't name the provider, so ask which route SJP uses.

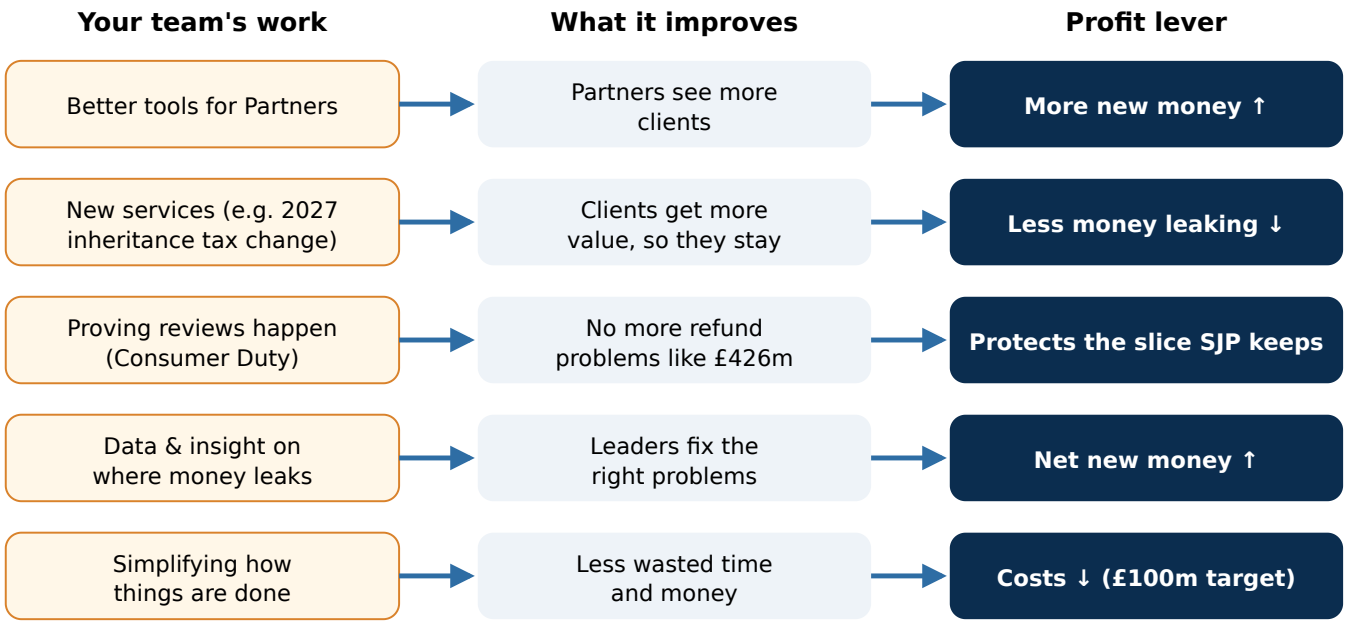
WHY IT'S VALUABLE

You'll understand exactly what Partners do, which makes your head-office work much better. Present it as "understanding the advice process from the inside", **not** as a way to become an adviser.

PART 3 · THE BIG PICTURE

How your work connects to profit

Remember the four profit levers from "How SJP makes its profit"? Head-office work mostly pushes on them through the Partners and clients.



YOUR "WHY THIS ROLE" LINE

"SJP's profit comes from the money its Partners look after. The Wealth Management team is where SJP makes its Partners more productive and its advice provably good. That brings more money in, keeps it there, and protects the margin. That's the part of the business I want to work in."

PART 4 · REVISION

Your 60-second summary

If you remember nothing else, learn this. It covers everything an interviewer expects you to know.

"St. James's Place is the UK's largest financial advice business. It looks after about **£240 billion** for over **a million clients** through around **5,000 self-employed advisers called Partners**. It's **vertically integrated**: it provides the advice and also owns the pensions, ISAs and funds clients invest in. It earns mainly through **yearly percentage fees**, and **pensions** are the biggest part.

Its clients are mostly comfortably-off people approaching or in retirement, professionals and business owners, who need help with complex decisions like retirement income and inheritance.

It's been through a tough period. Its fees were criticised as unclear, and in 2024 it set aside **£426m** to refund clients for reviews it couldn't prove had happened. Under the FCA's **Consumer Duty** it has since **simplified its fees, removed exit charges** and nearly finished the refunds.

Now it's moving into its **"Amplify"** growth phase. The key challenge is turning strong new money into stronger **net** growth. The Wealth Management division helps do that by making Partners more productive and advice provably good."

✓ Five things to say

1. "SJP's real strength is its ≈5,000 Partners and ≈95% client retention."
2. "The 2025 fee change made pricing clear, and new money now earns fees from day one."
3. "Consumer Duty moved the bar from telling clients to proving fair value."
4. "Gross inflows are strong; **net** inflows are the number to watch."
5. "Pensions entering inheritance tax in 2027 increases the need for advice."

✗ Five things to avoid

1. "SJP is a private bank for the super-rich." It isn't.
2. "The FCA fined SJP £426m." It didn't. That was SJP's own refund budget.
3. "SJP's advisers are independent." They're **restricted**.
4. "I want to become an adviser." This is a head-office role.
5. Exact share prices or disputed numbers. Use rounded figures instead.

TALKING ABOUT THE SCANDAL

Don't avoid it and don't dwell on it. Use the pattern **what happened → what SJP changed → what's still being finished**, in about 20 seconds, then move on.

PART 4 · GLOSSARY

Glossary: every term in plain English

Term	Meaning
Adviser / Partner	A qualified person who recommends what to do with your money. SJP's are self-employed "Partners".
Amplify / Strengthen	SJP's strategy phases: fixing the basics (2024–26), then growing (2027+).
Bond (in a portfolio)	A loan to a government or company that pays interest. Different from an "investment bond" wrapper.
Cashflow modelling	A year-by-year projection of someone's money to test plans like "can I retire at 60?".
Consumer Duty	FCA rules (2023) requiring good outcomes and fair value for customers, with proof.
Dividend / buyback	Ways a company returns profit to its shareholders: cash payments, or buying back its own shares.
Drawdown	Keeping a pension invested in retirement and taking income from it.
Exit fee (early withdrawal charge)	SJP's old charge of up to 6% for leaving within 6 years. Scrapped for new money in Aug 2025.
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority, the UK regulator.
Fund	A pot of pooled money invested by a professional manager.
FUM	Funds Under Management: all the client money a firm looks after.
Gross / net inflows	New money in / new money in minus money out.
Inheritance tax (IHT)	Tax on what you leave when you die. Unused pensions will count from April 2027.
ISA	A wrapper where up to £20k a year grows tax-free.
Level 4 Diploma	The qualification needed to give investment advice in the UK.
Pension	A tax-advantaged wrapper for retirement savings.
Polaris	SJP's biggest fund range (≈£94bn), with four risk levels.
Private bank	A bank for very wealthy clients (e.g. Coutts).
Provision	Money a company sets aside in its accounts for an expected future cost (e.g. SJP's £426m for refunds).
Restricted vs independent	Restricted advisers recommend a limited range of products (SJP); independent advisers can recommend anything.
Retention	The share of client money that stays each year (SJP ≈95%).
Suitability report	The written explanation of why advice suits a particular client.
Targeted support	New FCA category (April 2026): simpler, cheaper help that falls short of full advice.
Vertical integration	One company owning several stages of what the customer buys (for SJP: advice, product and funds).

Wealth management	Helping people plan and look after their money over their whole life.
Wrapper	The tax "box" investments sit in: pension, ISA, investment bond, unit trust.

Sources: SJP Full Year Results 2025 and Half Year 2026 reports, SJP charges announcement (2025), FCA publications, and press coverage (Investment Week, Money Marketing, Sharecast, City AM). See the companion packs for detailed source links. Prepared 6 November 2026.